

CERTIFICATION FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

These questions and answers are based upon current laws and regulations and are subject to change by the State Board of Education and/or the Professional Standards and Teacher Education Board.

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GENERAL FAQ

What type of certificates are available in Maryland?

Type of Certificate	Validity Period	Limit
Conditional Certificate	2 years	2
Standard Professional I Certificate	5 years	1
Standard Professional II Certificate	5 years	1
Advanced Professional Certificate	5 years	unlimited

RENEWAL FAQ

How do I renew my Conditional Certificate?

To get a second Conditional Certificate, a teacher must complete a minimum of 12 credits listed on the conditional evaluation and must meet the Maryland qualifying score on Praxis I.

How do I renew my Standard Professional I Certificate?

Complete a total of 6 credits, reading credits if you have not satisfied your requirement, during the five-year validity period. Since you will have a total of ten years to complete your master's degree or master's equivalency, you will probably want to take more than just the 6 required credits. You also must have a minimum of three years of successful teaching experience during the validity period of your certificate.

How do I renew my Standard Professional II Certificate?

By the end of the five-year validity period of your Standard Professional II certificate, you must complete either a master's degree or master's equivalent (*36 credits, 21 must be taken at the graduate level and the remaining 15 can be any combination of undergraduate, graduate, or MSDE credits). You also must have a minimum of three years of successful teaching experience during the validity period of your certificate.

What must I do to renew my Advanced Professional Certificate?

You must complete a total of 6 credits and/or equivalent credits during the five-year validity period of each Advanced Professional Certificate. You also must have a minimum of three years of successful teaching experience during the validity period of each certificate.

What courses are acceptable for certificate renewal?

All coursework must be taken at a regionally accredited college or university or through MSDE and must be related to education in general or your certification area.

What is Equivalent Credit? Can anyone use these credits to renew a certificate?

Equivalent credit is awarded for specified professional development experiences. **APC certificate holders ONLY** may renew their certificates with equivalent credit and/or undergraduate, graduate or MSDE credits. Equivalent credits are specific to CCPS and can only be used to renew an Advanced Professional Certificate. A list of options and other pertinent information is available on the following websites:

[Professional Development Plan](#)

[Professional Development Activities](#)

Who is responsible for renewing my certificate?

You are responsible for keeping track of your current certificate and its validity period. You need to keep track of the coursework that you complete and be sure to send original transcripts/official grade reports to Human Resources for all coursework completed.

College transcripts and grade reports must be requested by the certificate holder. Human Resources will make a request for your certificate to MSDE about two months before your certificate expires after all official documentation is received for your renewal credits.

You are also now required to log in to your TEACH portal and request renewal.

Is there a fee to renew my certificate? How do I pay it?

There is a \$10 certification renewal fee, but the addition of a certification area costs nothing. The renewal fee will be deducted from your biweekly pay as long as an authorization form is on file.

[Certification Fee Authorization Form](#)

ADVANCED PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATE FAQ

When am I eligible for my Advanced Professional Certificate?

After you have three years of school level teaching, administrative or specialist experience and a master's degree or equivalent *(see above) you are eligible for the APC Certificate. There is a pay increase associated with the APC certificate so it is advantageous to apply for it as soon as you are eligible.

How do I request the APC?

You can request the APC by requesting a renewal in the TEACH portal. It is not automatically requested unless your current certificate is expiring. The pay increase will go into effect the first day of the month after the request is made and transcripts are received by certification@ccps.org.

When am I eligible for a Master's plus pay increase?

You are eligible for the **Master's plus 30** when you have a conferred master's degree and 30 additional credits. A minimum of 27 credits must be taken at the graduate level and 3 credits can be MSDE credits. You are eligible for the **Master's plus 60** when you have a conferred master's degree and 60 additional credits. A minimum of 54 credits must be taken at the graduate level and 6 credits can be MSDE credits.

How do I request the Master's plus 30/60 pay increase?

You can request the Master's plus 30/60 by emailing certification@ccps.org. It is not automatically requested. The pay increase will go into effect the first day of the month after the request is made.

Other FAQ (adding an endorsement, ancillary credits, senior exemption, and certificate copies)

How may I add a certification area to my certificate?

You may add a teaching certification area by completing 30 credits in a particular certification area or by passing the content praxis test(s) for a specific certification area with a Maryland qualifying score. Please reach out to certification@ccps.org to verify the correct Praxis test for adding an endorsement.

Specialist certifications (Media, Guidance, Reading Specialists, etc.) and Administrator certification require a course by course evaluation or the conferral of a master's degree in the appropriate area. Evaluations are completed by the Certification Specialist upon request. Please submit a request to certification@ccps.org.

How and when do I get my actual certificate?

Upon renewal your certificate and certification renewal requirements will be emailed to the email address on file in your TEACH portal. You can print your certificate from the MSDE website whenever you wish. To do so, access your TEACH portal at <https://certificationhub.msde.maryland.gov/#/>. You need to set up an account the first time you access the site. After that, you simply need your username and the password you created on the site when you registered.

What is the Senior Teacher Waiver and how do I know if I am eligible for it?

According to COMAR 13A.12.01.14B.(1)(2), a teacher who has 25 years of experience in public education or is 55 years of age may request the Senior Teacher Waiver for certificate renewal. That means that the teacher is exempted from taking the 6 credits to renew his/her certificate and is not held to the reading or special education required courses that

have not yet been met. **Senior exemption does not apply to those holding a school counselor or visually impaired certification area.**

TEACH FAQ

What is TEACH?

The **E**ducator **A**pplication and **C**ertification **H**ub (**TEACH**), is an online portal for educator certification. This portal is mandatory for all Maryland certificate holders.

Do I need to create a portal account?

ALL applicants and certificate holders **MUST** complete a one-time registration by visiting TEACH at <https://certificationhub.msde.maryland.gov/#/> and clicking on the Register button.

Do I need to upload transcripts in TEACH?

No. CCPS Human Resources Office will still collect all transcripts, employment verifications, CPD credit forms, and PDPs. Please send via the pony to the attention of certification or via email to certification@ccps.org.

When do I utilize TEACH?

RENEWAL, ENDORSEMENTS, INITIAL APPLICATIONS

You will now need to request **renewal** of your certificate at the expiration of the validity period. You will receive an email from CCPS Educator Certification 6 months prior to the expiration reminding you to request renewal in the TEACH portal and if any additional credits are needed.

Requesting a new endorsement? You will need to submit a request to certification@ccps.org along with Praxis test scores or transcript AND submit a request in your TEACH account for an endorsement.

New to Maryland or recent graduate? You will need to **register** a portal account and request **INITIAL APPLICATION**.

FOR ADDITIONAL TEACH INFORMATION AND STEP BY STEP INSTRUCTIONS, PLEASE VISIT THE CCPS TEACH WEBSITE AT <https://www.ccps.org/Page/4301>.

For additional information about certification please contact certification@ccps.org